

Experiment 3: tree, head, tail

Aim

To practice directory visualization and viewing the beginning/end of files:

- `tree` - Hierarchical directory listing
- `head` - Display the first few lines of a file (default 10)
- `tail` - Display the last few lines of a file (default 10)

Procedure

1. Open Terminal.
2. Run the `tree` command:
`tree`
3. Display only first level:
`tree -L 1`
4. View the first 5 lines of `/etc/passwd`:
`head -n 5 /etc/passwd`
5. View the last 5 lines of `/etc/passwd`:
`tail -n 5 /etc/passwd`

Sample Output / Results

tree command:

```
$ tree -L 1
.
├── Documents
├── Downloads
... (directory structure displayed)
```

head command:

```
$ head -n 5 /etc/passwd
root:x:0:0:root:/root:/bin/bash
daemon:x:1:1:daemon:/usr/sbin:/usr/sbin/nologin
bin:x:2:2:bin:/bin:/usr/sbin/nologin
sys:x:3:3:sys:/dev:/usr/sbin/nologin
sync:x:4:65534:sync:/bin:/bin/sync
```

tail command:

```
$ tail -n 5 /etc/passwd
systemd-network:x:998:998:systemd Network Management:/:/usr/sbin/nologin
systemd-timesync:x:997:997:systemd Time Synchronization:/:/usr/sbin/nologin
messagebus:x:100:102:/:/nonexistent:/usr/sbin/nologin
systemd-resolve:x:996:996:systemd Resolver:/:/usr/sbin/nologin
polkitd:x:995:995:User for polkitd:/:/usr/sbin/nologin
```

Session Actions Edit View Help

zsh: corrupt history file /home/kali/.zsh_history

(kali@kali)-[~]

\$ nano file.txt

(kali@kali)-[~]

\$ tree

```
├── boot.img
├── Desktop
├── Documents
├── Downloads
│   ├── experiment 1
│   └── experiment 1-3
├── file.txt
├── LinuxLab
│   ├── Folder1
│   └── Folder2
├── Music
├── notes.txt
├── passwords.txt
├── password.txt
├── Pictures
│   ├── experiment 1
│   ├── Screenshot_2026-07-19_04_34_17.png
│   ├── Screenshot_2026-07-19_04_52_56.png
│   ├── Screenshot_2026-07-29_08_54_48.png
│   ├── Screenshot_2026-07-29_08_54_52.png
│   ├── Screenshot_2026-07-29_08_55_11.png
│   ├── Screenshot_2026-08-03_00_40_23.png
│   ├── Screenshot_2026-08-03_00_40_47.png
│   ├── Screenshot_2026-08-03_00_52_03.png
│   ├── Screenshot_2026-08-03_02_27_14.png
│   ├── Screenshot_2026-08-03_02_27_18.png
│   └── Screenshot_2026-08-03_02_28_08.png
├── Projects
├── Public
├── Templates
├── test.sh
├── username.txt
├── users.txt
├── users.txt.save
└── Videos
```

14 directories, 22 files

(kali@kali)-[~]

\$ head file.txt

```
Line1
Line2
Line3
Line4
```

└─ Videos

14 directories, 22 files

```
(kali㉿kali)-[~]  
└─$ head file.txt
```

Line1
Line2
Line3
Line4
Line5
Line6
Line7
Line8
Line9
Line10

```
(kali㉿kali)-[~]  
└─$ head -5 file.txt
```

Line1
Line2
Line3
Line4
Line5

```
(kali㉿kali)-[~]  
└─$ tail file.txt
```

Line1
Line2
Line3
Line4
Line5
Line6
Line7
Line8
Line9
Line10

```
(kali㉿kali)-[~]  
└─$ tail -3 file.txt
```

Line8
Line9
Line10